



Twitter app exploit

Researcher claims to have matched 17 million phone numbers to Twitter user accounts by exploiting app bug <https://dgit.in/jan20-69>



ToTok, a spy app?

US officials have alleged that ToTok, a popular chat app is actually a spying tool by the UAE Govt <https://dgit.in/jan20-70>

your scraping speed will be severely affected. There is where premium services such as SmartProxy come into the picture.

SmartProxy has over ten million proxy addresses through which your requests can be channelled. Moreover, their proxies originate from all corners of the world, so if the website that you

have browser plugins which integrate with iMacros to make your life easier.

CHANGE REQUEST PATTERN

Bots are often linear in their approach to scraping websites. They usually find the very first link on the page and then follow through to each and every link in a sequential manner, or if



CAPTCHAs are effective at blocking most bots

are trying to scrape has geo-fencing then a service like SmartProxy will help you get around that restriction.

COUNTER CAPTCHAS

One of the simplest ways to throw a bot or a scraper off is by having a CAPTCHA on your page. Older CAPTCHAs were quite easy to solve using tools but modern ones such as Recaptcha v2, FunCaptcha, and Geetest have become very adept at stopping bots. Then again not all websites will have CAPTCHAs. Some find it very intrusive to interrupt the user experience. There's a solution for that as well. Newer CAPTCHAs such as reCAPTCHA v3 don't interrupt the user. Instead they focus on analysing the user behaviour on the page and assigning them a score. A high score is netted by actual humans whereas obvious bots will score low. So much that those running bots have to resort to services which have actual humans resolving CAPTCHAs and returning the response.

Anti-CAPTCHA is one such service which charges as low as \$1.5 for every 1000 tokens that you send their way. They're quite proficient at solving JavaScript CAPTCHAs. They also

you've set it to scrape a folder then all pages are again accessed in sequence. This is very robotic and is easily recognisable by websites as a scraper. Ideally you'd want to randomise this particular sequence. Let's say if you had to scrap 0-20,000 URLs within a certain folder of a website, you should use a randomiser to pick a number between 0-20,000 and then begin scraping so that the requests do not appear to form a simple sequence.

Another way you can throw the bot off is by varying the request rate. Humans are very slow creatures so setting a low request rate will make it easier to mimic a human visitor.

FINAL WORDS

Folks who want to scrape websites and folks who don't want their websites to be scraped have been engaged in a never-ending cat-and-mouse game. Each time the scrapers figure out a new way to hide their bots, the website publisher has a month or two to wisen up and produce a counter.

The things mentioned in this article can easily be implemented using Selenium, your average browser and a few premium services. All we'd like to say at this point is "be nice".

*VIDEOS



*Advanced Scrapy

An advanced tutorial on using scrapy to scrape a complex website using JSON APIs.

<https://dgit.in/2F0BB80>



*Scrape with Node.js

Using node.js with the request-promise and cheerio libraries to scrape a site.

<https://dgit.in/377V2s2>



*Scraping Amazon

Using Parsehub to scrape Amazon for product data such as names, pricing and ASIN.

<https://dgit.in/2SvIZAZ>